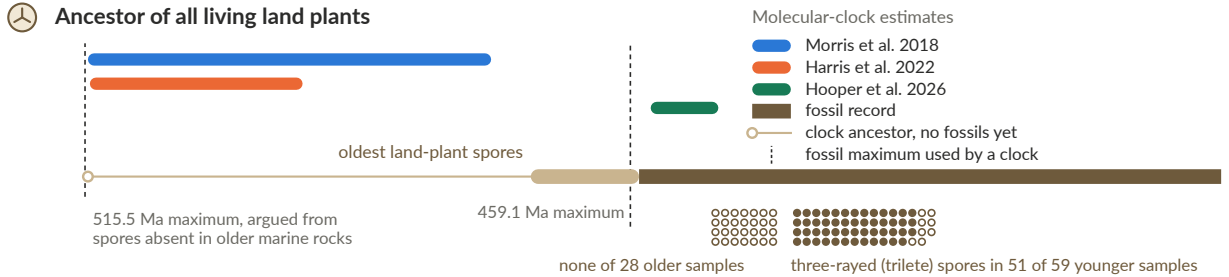
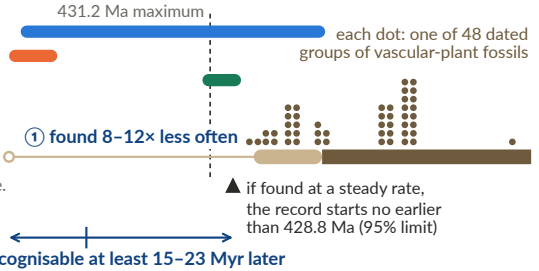
Older dates for living land plants fit the fossil record if early plants were found several times less often, or recognisable features evolved later.

Ancestor of all living land plants



Libyan boreholes: a steady flow of spores into these rocks since 459.1 Ma fits only below about a tenth of the later flow, as from rarer or more distant plants, or poorer delivery.

Ancestor of living vascular plants clubmosses, ferns and seed plants



The older clock dates (444–452 Ma) fit if early vascular plants were

① found 8–12× less often before their oldest fossil, or

② recognisable at least 15–23 million years after their ancestor.

Both are what the fossil record requires, not estimates of how common the plants were.

